4 Hello, Rails!

To begin with, let's get some text up on screen quickly. To do this, you need to get your Rails application server running.

4.1 Starting up the Web Server

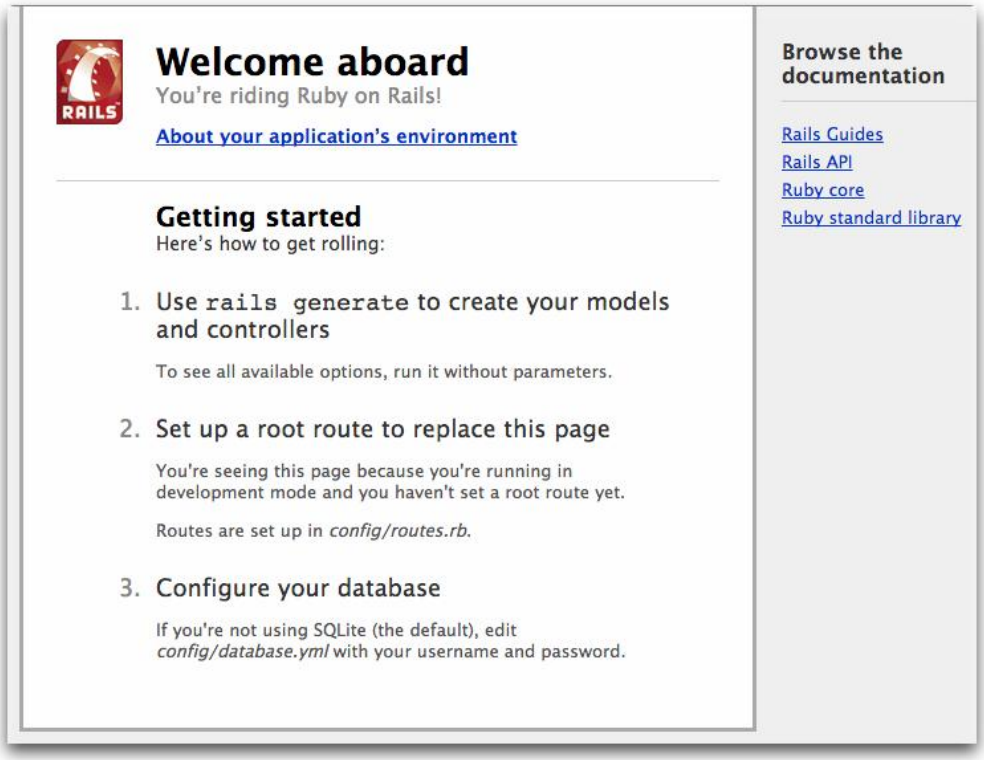
You actually have a functional Rails application already. To see it, you need to start a web server on your development machine. You can do this by running the following in the `blog` directory:

```
$ bin/rails server
```

If you are using Windows, you have to pass the scripts under the `bin` folder directly to the Ruby interpreter e.g. `ruby bin\rails server`.

Compiling CoffeeScript and JavaScript asset compression requires you have a JavaScript runtime available on your system, in the absence of a runtime you will see an `execjs` error during asset compilation. Usually Mac OS X and Windows come with a JavaScript runtime installed. Rails adds the `therubyracer` gem to the generated `Gemfile` in a commented line for new apps and you can uncomment if you need it. `therubyrhino` is the recommended runtime for JRuby users and is added by default to the `Gemfile` in apps generated under JRuby. You can investigate all the supported runtimes at ExecJS.

This will fire up WEBrick, a web server distributed with Ruby by default. To see your application in action, open a browser window and navigate to http://localhost:3000. You should see the Rails default information page:



To stop the web server, hit Ctrl+C in the terminal window where it's running. To verify the server has stopped you should see your command prompt cursor again. For most UNIX-like systems including Mac